

Defend Yourself

Perhaps the single most dreaded computing experience is when you find that your PC has been infected with a virus. Your data may be lost forever, and you can't keep your computer from crashing long enough to fix it. More often than not, you end up wasting precious constructive time trying to undo the damage caused.

The sad thing is, a majority of malicious software is written by some of the most brilliant computer minds across the world. Why, is a question best left unasked, as the working of individual human minds is too varied and complicated to comprehend.

This month, *Digit Fast Track* will take you through the world of viruses. You will find eight sections in this book, which will cover everything you need to know about viruses—from what viruses are and who makes them, to how to tell when, or check whether or not you have been infected, to killing the viruses.

Each section will demystify an aspect of viruses that every user should know. We start with the basics in Chapter I—from what a virus is, how it works and the different types of viruses, to other types of malicious software and how to tell whether you have been infected. Chapter Two introduces you to the knights in shining armour, called antivirus applications, and what you should look for when trusting one to defend your PC and your data. Chapter Three will give you a little history about viruses; Chapter Four details the precautions you need to take in order to stay safe from attack, and Chapter Five taken an in depth look at the best security software available today.

There is also a special White Papers section, where you can read some of the best literature ever written on this subject. There is also a Bibliography that recommends some excellent virus-related reading, both for the beginner and the expert, as well as a Glossary that demystifies hundreds of terms that may confuse you when reading about viruses or anti-virus technologies.

We hope this book is comprehensive enough to help the hundreds and thousands of readers to deal with and plan their security, and to keep their precious data safe from the millions of threats “out there”.